

Greek Civilisation

- The civilisation developed around 8 BC, when the small villages clustered to form city-states.
- They worshiped Zens (Sky God), Poseidon (Sea God), Apollo (Sun God), Athena (Goddess of victory) etc.
- In the Battle of Marathon in 490 BC Greeks defeated king Darius I. Alexander was the Greek ruler.
- The olympic games originated in Greece. Iliad and Odyssey are among the best epic of the world written by Homen of Greece.

Roman Civilisation

- Italy was the centre of civilisation. The city of Rome was founded by Romulus in 1000 BC on the bank of Tiber River. The war between Carthage and Rome is known as Punic War (264 BC to 146 BC).
- Julius Caesar, one of the generals, murdered Pompey, another general and occupied the throne. He was attached to the Egyptian queen Cleopatra. Caesar was succeeded by Octavian and Diocletion.
- Romans worshiped the planets and developed latin language.
- Concrete was invented by Roman which is even today used for construction of buildings.

MAJOR REVOLUTIONS

- Revolutions have occurred through human history and vary widely in terms of methods, duration and motivating ideology. Their results includes major changes in culture, economy and socio-political institutions.
- Several generations of scholarly thoughts on revolutions have generated many competing theories and contribution much to the current understanding of this complex phenomenon.

The Renaissance

- The renaissance is a period in European history from 14th to 17th centuries regarded as the cultural bridge between the Middle Ages and Modern History.
- The intellectual basis of the Renaissance was its own invented version of humanism, derived from the rediscovery of the classical Greek Philosophy. Such as that of Protagoras, who said that, "Man is the measure of all things".
- In politics, the Renaissance contributed to the development of the customs and conventions of diplomacy, and in science to an increased reliance on observation and inductive reasoning.
- During the Renaissance, money and art went hand in hand. Artists depended entirely on Patron while the Patrons needed money to foster artistic talent.

Reformation

- It was a Schism from the Roman catholic church initiated by Martin Luther and continued by John Calvin, and other early protestant reformers in early 16th century in Europe.
- Luther began it by criticising the selling of indulgences, insisting that pope had no authority over Purgatory and that the catholic doctrine of the merits of saints had no foundation in the Gospel.
- The new movement influenced the Church of England decisively after 1547 under Edward VI and Elizabeth I.
- The Church of England had been made independent under Henry VIII in the early 1530s for political rather than religious reasons.

Industrial Revolution

- Industrial revolution was started around the second half of the 18th century. This period witnessed changes in the manufacturing processes from slow to faster and expensive hand production to cheaper machine production.
- Industrial revolution started in England to fulfil the growing demands for goods, both at domestic and international level.
- A number of factors contributed to industrial revolution in England. *They are as follows*
 - England had great deposits of coal and iron ores.
 - England was a politically stable society as well as the world's leading colonial power, which meant its colonies could serve as a source for raw materials, as well as a market place for manufactured goods.
 - As demand for goods increased, merchants needed more cost-effective methods of production, which led to rise of mechanisation and the factory system.
 - The agricultural sector of the British economy had been steadily growing during the 18th century. Agricultural stability allowed the British population to increase.
- The industrial revolution started chiefly from the Textile Industry. In 1733, a weaver called John Kay invented a **Flying Shuttle**, by which the work of weaving could be done quickly.
- In 1785, Edmund Cartwright invented '**Powerloom**' Elly Whitley invented a cotton ginning machine called **cotton gin**. James Watt invented the steam engine, the first railway line was built between Manchester and Liverpool in 1830.
- The growth of production increased the wealth of the Great Britain and by 1815, England emerged as the greatest banker and the largest carrier of goods in the world.
- Due to the industrial revolution, by the close of the 19th century, science and technology became an integral part of Western society.

The American Revolution

- American revolution is also called as American Revolutionary War (1775-83). The conflict arose from growing tensions between residents of Great Britain's 13 North American colonies and the colonial government, which represented the British crown.
- In 1765, members of American colonial society rejected the authority of the British Parliament to tax them and to create other laws affecting them without colonial representatives in the government.
- The Battles of the American revolution started in Lexington on 19th April, 1775. These were over 20 major battles during the revolution spanning over a period of 6 years.
- General George Washington, with the help of France and his continental army defeated British General Cornwallis at the Battle of Yorktown on 19th October, 1781.
- Finally, the Treaty of Paris ended the revolution officially on 3rd September, 1783.

BOSTON TEA PARTY

- During the following decade, protests continued to escalate by colonists (known as Patriots) in the Boston Tea Party in 1773, during which patriots destroyed a consignment of taxed tea from the Parliament controlled and favoured East India Company.
- The British responded by imposing punitive laws on Massachusetts in 1774 known as the Coercive Acts.
- In late 1774, the Patriots set-up their own alternative government to better coordinate their resistance efforts against Great Britain, while other colonists, known as Loyalists remained align to the British Crown.

Causes of Success

- **French Involvement** After the American victory at Saratoga, the French in 1778 (later Spain in 1779 and Holland in 1780) realised the Britain could be defeated, and they joined the fight against the British. Without France's military power, the Americans would never have had the capacity of defeating the superior British army.
- **Distance** Since, the British Government was geographically separated from the places of battle, it was difficult for it to effectively manage and communicate with troops.
- **Fighting on Home Soil** British armies were not familiar with the climate and rugged terrain of America. Therefore, the colonists had the geographical advantage because they knew how to survive the land.

- **Guerilla Warfare** British armies were not acclimated to guerilla warfare, which the colonists had used during their wars with the Indians. Therefore, the British could not defend themselves well against a fighting strategy they had never seen before. Washington's use of these and other defensive strategies allowed for considerable American advantage.
- **Popular Support** Many colonists, even if they weren't fighting, were supportive of the cause. Popular support boosted morale among soldiers and encouraged them to push through the tough times.

The French Revolution

- The French revolution took place between 1789 and 1799. It ended in 1799 with the overthrow of the government (Council of 500 in Paris) by **Napoleon Bonaparte**.
- The French revolution paved the way for the secular system of governance, which is prevalent in most of the countries of the modern world.

Causes of French Revolution

- Social and economic unrest triggered the revolution. The country was facing a deteriorating economic condition coupled with a lag between the intellectual development and social political condition that was stagnant.
- The middle class, also known as the **Bourgeoisie** was in worst condition. This educated class was heavily taxed whereas the ruling nobles and the clergy were exempted from taxation.
- During the summer of 1789, France faced a financial crisis, caused primarily by military expenditures and a parasitic aristocracy.
- The revolution was further consolidated by the oath of the 'Tennis Court'. From there onwards, began the civil disobediences that would eventually pave the way for the revolutionary regime.
- In the events that were to follow the National Assembly did frame a Constitution, which could restore the social unrest, but the differences led to further mishaps.
- The period is known as the **reign of terror** as many executions were held and all efforts were taken to curb any counter revolutionary activities.
- The Thermidorian Reaction, which was eventually overthrown by means of a military coup under the leadership of **Napoleon Bonaparte**, who put an end to the revolution by declaring himself the 'First Council of France'.
- After the defeat of Napoleon, the old ruling dynasty of France was restored to power. However, within a few years in 1830, there was another outbreak of revolution.
- In 1848, the Monarchy was again overthrown though it soon reappeared. Finally, in 1871, the Republic was again proclaimed.

Significance of the French Revolution

- The French revolution led to the preservation and popularisation of the important theories and ideals of **liberty, equality and fraternity** and the theories of **nationalism, democracy** etc.
- The ‘**Napoleonic Code**’, which consisted of a civil code, codes of civil procedure and criminal procedure, a penal code and a commercial code proved beneficial not only to the France, but also to the whole world.

Imperialism and Colonialism

Imperialism is a policy of a nation to extend its control outside its own boundaries, by acquisition of colonies or dependencies or by jurisdiction over other races.

- During the 17th and 18th centuries the policy of mercantilism became popular, which accentuated the importance of competition, for overseas trade and colonies.
- The process of colonisation of Asia began towards the close of 15th century, when **Vasco da Gama** discovered the sea route to India.
- The weakness of Chinese Empire became apparent during the first Opium war of 1840-42. At that time England occupied Hong Kong. In 1857-58, England and France forced China to subscribe to the Treaty of Tientsin according to which China had to give special facilities to Britain, France, Russia and America.
- Taking advantages of the Chinese weakness France took Cochin China under its protection, occupied Annam and Tokin in 1882 and formed the protectorate of Indo-China.
- In Central Asia, Russia and Britain tried to increase their influence. While the Northern part of Persia was to be controlled by Russia, the Southern part was opened for the British.
- The motives of imperialism and empire building were selfish and the people in the colonies were frequently exploited for the benefit of the mother country.

The Russian Revolution

- The Russian revolution was a time of economic and social reconstruction in the Soviet Union.
- The March revolution (First revolution) overthrew the Tsar and set-up a moderate provisional government.
- When, this government coped no better than Tsar, it was itself overthrown by the Bolshevik revolution in November.

The February Revolution

- The February revolution, which removed Tsar Nicholas II from power, developed spontaneously out of a series of increasingly violent demonstrations and riots on the streets of Petrograd.
- Though, the February revolution was a popular uprising, it did not necessarily express the wishes of the majority of Russian population.

The October Revolution

- The October revolution is also called as Bolshevik Revolution, overturned the interim provisional government and established the Soviet Union.
- The Bolsheviks, who led this coup, prepared their coup in only six months.
- By October 1917, the Bolsheviks popular base was much larger, they built up a majority of support within petrograd and other urban centres.
- After October revolution, the Bolsheviks faced major opposition from Russia and for many different reasons.
- The result was the Russian Civil War, which would be horrifically painful for the country and that, in the end, would cost even more lives than World War I.

World War I

- *The four basic causes that led to the horrifying conflict of World War I were as follow*
 - i. The system of alliances
 - ii. The militarism and arms race
 - iii. The force of nationalism
 - iv. Imperialism and economic rivalry
- Often nationalism led to rivalries and conflicts between nations. Additionally various ethnic groups resented domination by others and wanted independence.
- By 1890, Germany built a strong army and developed a navy to rival England's fleet. *By 1907, there were two major alliances*
 - i. Allies or Triple Entente : Consisting of France, Britain and Russia.
 - ii. Central powers or Triple Alliance : Consisting Germany Austria, Hungary, Italy and Rumania.
- The assassination of **Archduke Franz Ferdinand**, heir to the Austrian throne in June, 1914 sparked the initiation of World War I.
- The Great War of 1914 was probably outcome of the Balkan Wars. In these wars Germany exercised restraint over Austria and France over Russia. War started as soon as the restrains were not exercised in 1914.
- The World War I caused great economic loss, wastage and vast destruction. Nearly 10 billion rupees were directly spent over the war.

The Treaty of Versailles

- Germany had to sign the Treaty of Versailles that led to many harsh restrictions on Germany.
- The provinces of Alsace and Lorraine were taken away from Germany and they were given back to France.
- Germany had to give Eupen and Malmedy to Belgium. The Polish territories were taken back from the possession of Germany, Austria and Russia.
- Germany lost her rights in China, Turkey, Egypt, Morocco and Bulgaria.

World War II

- Between 1939 to 1945 World War II remains the most geographically widespread military conflict the world has ever seen.
- The Treaty of Versailles been drafted with a foresight and Germany meted with a lenient treatment, the World War II might have been averted. Hence, the short sighted and selfishness of the victor powers was the root cause of World War II.
- The German people were angered that their government accepted the lopsided Treaty of Versailles. These sentiments allowed Adolf Hitler to seize power in Germany.
- Firstly in order to avoid war, Europe gave in to Hitler's demands. But, when Hitler invaded Poland in 1939, England and France promptly declared war on Germany.
- Nazi secret police brutally enforced German policies, Millions of Hitler's enemies were sent to the concentration camps.
- Hitler denounced the clauses of the Treaty of Versailles on 16th March, 1935. On 1st April, 1935, the League of Nations formally condemned Germany's repudiation of the treaty.
- Hitler re-occupied the Rhineland in March, 1936 by sending German troops into the Western German zone.
- Hitler was a success in concluding several pacts and ultimately he alienated the sympathies of France from Italy.
- Japan entered World War II with an aim to dominate for East. Encouraged by Hitler's success she bombed the American naval base at Pearl Harbour.
- About 50 million people are estimated to die in the World War II, with 17 million of these deaths having occurred in Asia and the Pacific.

Causes of the World War II

There are nine main causes of World War II, which are as follows

- i. Aggressive nationalism of Germany.
- ii. Rise of Fascism in Italy.
- iii. Japanese Imperialism.

- iv. Dissatisfaction of National Minorities of Europe.
- v. Economic Depression in Western countries.
- vi. Failure of the League of Nations.
- vii. Failure of Disarmament.
- viii. Ideological conflict between fascism and democracy.
- ix. Attitude of Western powers towards Russia.
- x. Imposed Treaty of Versailles.

Capitalism

- Capitalism is a social system based on the principle of individual rights. Politically, it is the system of laissez-faire (freedom).
- Following the demise of feudalism, the capitalism became the dominant economic system in the Western world.
- A remarkable confluence of advances in agriculture, cotton spinning and weaving iron manufacture and machine tool design and the harnessing of mechanical power began to alter the character of capitalism profoundly in the last years of the 18th century and the first decades of the 19th century.
- The form of capitalism differs between nations, because the practice of it is embedded within cultures. Markets cater to national culture as much as national culture mutates to conform to the discipline of profit and loss.
- The Great Depression of the 1930 brought the policy of laissez-faire (non-interference by the state in economic matters) to an end in most countries and for a time cast doubt on the capitalist system as a whole.
- The performance of capitalism since World War II in the United States the United Kingdom, West Germany and Japan, however, has given evidence of its continued vitality.

Communism

- Communism is the political and economic doctrine that aims to replace private property and a profit-based economy with public ownership at least the major means of production. (e.g. mines, mills, factories) and the natural resources of a society.
- Marx and Engels maintained that the poverty, disease and early death that afflicted the proletariat were endemic to capitalism. These problems could be resolved only by replacing capitalism with communism.
- Under communism the major means of industrial production such as mines, mills, factories and railroads would be publicly owned and operated for the benefit of all.
- Today, Mao's version of Marxism-Leninism remains active, but ambiguous force elsewhere in Asia, most notably in Nepal.
- After a decade of armed struggle, Maoist insurgents in Nepal agreed in 2006 to lay down their arms and participated in national elections to choose an assembly to rewrite the Nepalese Constitution.

Socialism

- Socialism as a political philosophy is the social and economic doctrine that calls for public rather than private ownership or control of property and natural resources.
- The origins of socialism as a political movement lie in the Industrial revolution.
- According to the socialist view, individuals do not live or work in isolation, but live in cooperation with one another.
- Everything that people produce is in some sense a social product and everyone, who contributes to the production of a good is entitled to a share in it.
- The World War II forged an uneasy alliance between communists and socialists and between liberals and conservatives in their common struggle against fascism.
- The terms such as African socialism and Arab socialism were frequently invoked in the 1950s and 60s, partly because the old colonial powers were identified with capitalist imperialism.

Nazism and Fascism

- Adolf Hitler made his first appearance in German political scene in 1923. Hitler's Nazi Party conducted its activities with military fanfares. By November 1923, Hitler was in total control of Nazi Party.
- Hitler followed a three fold plan to consolidate the Nazis in power. It comprised capturing the legal authority to rule, crashing the country's political opposition and eliminating rivals within his party.
- Hitler infused the German people with the ideas of racism, which convinced them that they were superior people with the right to rule over inferior people.
- Fascism was political ideology antithetical to democracy, parliamentarism, individual liberty, freedom of expression and state control over businesses.
- Mussolini organised the *fasci di combattimento* (Band of Combatants) in Milan in 1919, providing the basis for the rise of fascism.
- Mussolini won popularity among the ordinary masses of Italians by starting huge public projects.
- Fascism contributed significantly to the unstable security environment of Europe, which took the world towards the World War II.